

Jonathan Kyle Hobson

UX Researcher | Product Research & Research Operations

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Portfolio: jonathankhobson.github.io/portfolio/research

Summary

UX researcher focused on the evidence behind product decisions. Combine surveys, usability studies, and qualitative synthesis to clarify audience needs and guide the next iteration. Build practical research workflows and communicate findings with designers, engineers, and stakeholders, drawing on experience in AI products and digital learning.

Skills

Mixed-method research · Survey design and analysis · Usability testing · Interviews · Qualitative coding · Heuristic evaluation · Research planning · Participant recruitment · Stakeholder workshops · Dovetail · Qualtrics · Figma

Experience

FactorLab

UX Designer & Researcher (Contract) | Oct 2025–Present

- Investigate usability breakdowns across SmartTagIt's web and mobile product, connecting heuristic findings and stakeholder feedback with Figma prototypes and engineering decisions.
- Clarify questions about conversation entry, incomplete AI responses, and recovery; document assumptions, alternatives, and technical constraints before recommending changes.

Oak AI

Lead UX Researcher | 2023–2025

- Led survey design, launch, and analysis for an audience study with 1,459 completed submissions (March 14, 2025 snapshot), translating reported barriers into recommendations for clearer next actions.
- Coded privacy-community observations in Dovetail, identifying themes of control, transparency, and corporate accountability; findings supported reconsidering audience assumptions and the next research investment.
- Conducted desktop heuristic evaluation and usability testing; partnered with design and engineering to prioritize navigation, labeling, and error-recovery improvements.
- Created screeners, study plans, participant-recruitment workflows, and shared research records to support repeatable follow-up studies.

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UX Research | Experience continued

Oppia Foundation

Volunteer | Sep 2025–Present

- Currently serve as UX Research Lead. Review lesson-player interactions with designers and engineers, clarifying questions about saved progress, exit decisions, and recovery before refining the experience.
- Created and shared heuristic-evaluation resources for cross-functional product review.

KeepMake

UX Research Consultant | Jun 2023–Present

- Use heuristic reviews, prototypes, and usability work to investigate product friction and help stakeholders define the next learning objective.
- Advised on a manageable activation study, separating usability questions from adoption goals and proposing onboarding and repeat-use signals for a volunteer team.

Arizona State University, Learning Innovations

AI Analyst | Feb 2024–Oct 2024

- Designed and evaluated voice and chat flows, translating learner and staff needs into conversational prototypes and findings for project leaders.
- Proposed an ASU for Life prompt workflow with mentor checkpoints to review learner context, assess output accuracy, and refine recommended tasks.

Arizona State University, Knowledge Enterprise

Instructional Designer | Apr 2022–Oct 2024

- Developed digital learning materials and workshops, incorporating accessibility improvements and AI-supported content workflows for diverse learners.

Selected project

Oppia Research Compass | Independent research tool

Built a local, read-only tool for retrieving historical research with source references and helping frame new research questions.

Education

MS User Experience (UX Research) | Arizona State University | 2024

BS Technical Communication (UX) | Arizona State University | 2023

BS Electronic Media | Northern Arizona University | 2014